

# Our Methodology

## Our Approach

The Google Career Certificates program's impact data is derived from two core data sources: Certificate program participant surveys and labor market analysis.

### I. Learner Survey Data

- **Data Collection:** We gather insights from certificate program enrollees through surveys at key points:
  - **Entry Survey:** Administered in-platform to learners upon commencement of a certificate program. Primarily used for learner-based claims.
  - **Completion Survey:** Presented in-platform and via email to learners upon completion of a certificate program.
- **Scope:** Data reflects responses from certificate program participants in the United States.
- **Time Period:** January 1, 2024 - December 31, 2024.
- **Survey Integrity:**
  - All claims are derived from anonymized, aggregated and de-duplicated data to ensure accurate data representation.
  - Responses to questions about "at program start" circumstances are based on the earliest survey submission for each learner.
  - "Prefer not to answer" responses are excluded from calculations to maintain data integrity.

### II. Labor Market Data

- **Source:** Labor market insights are drawn from Lightcast, a leading provider of job market analytics.
- **Scope:** The geographic scope of Lightcast data includes the United States.
- **Analysis:** Our approach to labor market analysis varies depending on the certificate type:
  - **Occupation-Based:** For entry-level certificates, subject matter experts identify relevant Lightcast Occupations, and metrics are calculated by aggregating data across these occupations.
  - **Skill-Based:** For Career Essentials courses, the Google data team selects a set of Lightcast Skills that best align with skills and topics covered in the course
  - **Data Integrity and Transparency:** We're committed to ensuring the data presented is accurate, reliable, and transparent. This methodology is consistently reviewed and refined to reflect the latest best practices in data analysis.